Baltimore, Maryland

Strategic IT Landscape and Market Analysis Report

April 3, 2026

1. Executive Summary & Macro Landscape

The City of Baltimore, Maryland, is currently navigating a complex and highly transitional phase characterized by ambitious urban revitalization efforts, aggressive digital modernization mandates, and significant macroeconomic headwinds. Mayor Brandon M. Scott's administration has set forth a sweeping agenda for Fiscal Year (FY) 2026, underscored by a $4.63 total adopted budget, broken down into a $3.7 billion operating budget and a $932 million capital budget encapsulated within a broader six-year Capital Improvement Program (CIP).[3] The administration's overarching theme for the 2026 State of the City address, "Building Together, Block by Block," highlights a localized, community-centric approach to governance, but the execution of this vision relies entirely on enterprise-grade technological enablement.[1]

From an economic perspective, Baltimore presents a juxtaposition of robust localized revenue generation and acute external vulnerability. The city projects general fund revenues to reach approximately $2.6 billion in FY 2026, representing an 11% increase from the prior fiscal year.[3] This growth is primarily driven by rising property value assessments yielding $1.2 billion and localized income tax revenues generating roughly $500 million.[4] However, Baltimore City maintains the highest property tax rate in the state at 2.248%, placing a ceiling on the administration's ability to generate net-new revenue through tax hikes without alienating the residential and commercial tax base.[4] Consequently, the city is forced to look toward operational efficiencies, automation, and federal grant influxes to fund its ambitious programs.

These localized financial constraints are exacerbated by macro-level threats. The State of Maryland is currently grappling with a severe $3 billion structural budget deficit, compelling the state government to enact systemic fiscal restraint, delay mandated priorities, and scale back municipal grant distributions.[5] Furthermore, federal policy shifts and looming workforce downsizing pose a disproportionate risk to Baltimore, given that the city serves as a hub for approximately 12,000 federal jobs.[3] Any reduction in federal employment or localized spending directly threatens Baltimore's income tax base and consumer economy.

Despite these fiscal pressures, the Scott administration is aggressively pursuing several top-tier administrative goals for the current fiscal year, all of which require massive IT infrastructure investments to succeed:

The foremost administrative priority is public safety and violence reduction. The city has allocated a historic $1.2 billion to public safety initiatives for FY 2026.[6] Mayor Scott has continuously championed the Group Violence Reduction Strategy, treating violent crime as a public health epidemic that requires precise, data-driven interventions rather than blanket policing.[7] This approach has yielded tangible results, including a 25% reduction in homicides and a nearly 34% drop in non-fatal shootings as of late 2024.[8] Technologically, this mandate demands the continuous modernization of the city's 911 Computer-Aided Dispatch (CAD) systems, the expansion of the 800 MHz first-responder radio network, and the scaling of the CitiWatch surveillance camera network, which relies on massive unstructured data storage and

real-time video analytics.[9]

A secondary pillar of the administration's agenda is equitable neighborhood development and the creation of clean, healthy communities. The city is leveraging a massive $6.9 billion master plan known as "Downtown RISE" to revitalize the city center.[14] This comprehensive three-phase project involves major infrastructure upgrades, restoring the Red Line transit project, redesigning the downtown street grid to be safer and more pedestrian-friendly, and the rehabilitation of vacant housing.[14] To support these urban planning efforts, the central IT authority must deliver modernized Geographic Information Systems (GIS), streamlined digital permitting applications, and integrated asset management platforms that allow agencies like the Department of Public Works (DPW) and the Department of Transportation (DOT) to operate cohesively.[9]

Finally, digital equity remains a cornerstone of the city's technological ethos. Utilizing historic allocations from the American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA), including a dedicated $35 million investment, the city is rapidly expanding its FreeBmoreWiFi network across dozens of recreation and senior centers.[11] This initiative is paired with vast device procurement programs and community-led digital literacy grants aimed at bridging the digital divide for the city's most vulnerable populations, representing a massive expansion of the city's digital footprint and endpoint management requirements.[11]

For enterprise technology vendors like Dell Technologies, Baltimore City represents a highly lucrative, albeit complex, State and Local Government (SLG) market. The central IT authority's pivot toward consolidated governance, cloud-first architectures, and zero-trust security models creates a distinct whitespace for Dell's compute, storage, and advisory portfolios. However, penetrating this market requires a nuanced understanding of the city's internal chargeback frictions, its reliance on specific cooperative purchasing vehicles, and the political necessity of aligning infrastructure pitches directly to the Mayor's public safety and digital equity mandates.

2. Power Structure & Key Stakeholders

The technological purchasing power and strategic direction within Baltimore City are dictated by a tripartite structure: the executive branch which sets the vision and manages agency-level operations, the legislative branch which controls appropriations and exercises budgetary oversight, and the central IT authority, the Baltimore City Office of Information and Technology (BCIT), which serves as the technical architect and gatekeeper for enterprise standards. Understanding the spheres of influence and the public stances of these key stakeholders is critical for navigating the procurement lifecycle.

The following table categorizes the primary decision-makers, distinguishing between financial purchasers who control the budget and technical influencers who dictate the architectural requirements.

Name & Title	Sphere of Influence	Recent Public Stances on Technology & Operations
Brandon M. Scott Mayor, City of Baltimore	**Financial Purchaser / Executive Sponsor:** Drives the overall strategic vision, dictates capital budget allocations across agencies, and serves as the ultimate executive sponsor for major ARPA funding deployments.	Champions data-driven governance, digital equity, and the modernization of public safety infrastructure. Frequently emphasizes treating violence as a public health issue requiring analytical intervention. Strongly advocates for the "Downtown RISE" infrastructure overhaul.[1]
Danielle McCray City Councilwoman, Chair of the Budget & Appropriations Committee	**Financial Purchaser / Legislative Gatekeeper:** Controls the legislative approval of the city operating and capital budgets, CIP approvals, and the authorization of agency funding releases.	Highly focused on operational efficiency, agency vacancy rates, and technological workforce retention. Has publicly pressed agencies like DPW and DOT on severe staffing shortages, advocating for modernized internal systems and apprenticeship programs to ensure continuity of civic services.[10]
Faith P. Leach City Administrator	**Financial Purchaser / Operational Executive:** Oversees day-to-day city operations, inter-agency coordination, and the execution of the Mayor's Action Plan across all departments.	Instrumental in implementing the city's new data governance structure. Views technology as the engine for civic efficiency. Focuses on treating data as a vital corporate asset to improve the quality, equity, and transparency of citizen-facing services.[16]

Name & Title	Sphere of Influence	Recent Public Stances on Technology & Operations
T.J. Mayotte Chief Information Officer (CIO), BCIT	**Technical Influencer / Primary IT Decision Maker:** Heads BCIT. Manages the $53M+ IT operating budget, directs enterprise architecture, and leads the city's digital transformation agenda.	Appointed in March 2026. Brings over two decades of SLG and private sector experience, including serving as CIO of Howard County and holding private sector CISO roles. Highly focused on high-impact digital transformations, security governance, and expanding the city's digital equity footprint.[18]
Kenya Asli Interim Director of Broadband & Digital Equity, BCIT	**Technical Influencer / Program Owner:** Directs the Office of Broadband and Digital Equity within BCIT, managing the execution of the $35M ARPA broadband allocation.	Focuses almost exclusively on deploying community Wi-Fi (FreeBmoreWiFi), managing the Digital Equity Fund grants, and establishing public-private partnerships to distribute hardware and close the digital divide in historically disenfranchised neighborhoods.[13]
Justin Elszasz Chief Data Officer, Baltimore Digital	**Technical Influencer / Analytics Lead:** Leads the Baltimore Digital team and the City Performance Team housed within the Mayor's Office.	Advocates for agile, human-centered design in civic tech. Focuses on deploying tools that are simpler, cheaper, and more rapidly deployable than traditional monolithic IT projects. Heavily emphasizes data analytics and performance management metrics (CitiStat).[16]

Name & Title	Sphere of Influence	Recent Public Stances on Technology & Operations
Permanent CISO *(Data Unavailable - Position in Transition)*	**Technical Influencer / Security Gatekeeper:** Mandates cybersecurity frameworks, zero-trust rollouts, incident response, and compliance auditing.	The city utilizes acting/deputy personnel and external managed services for this role amid ongoing reorganizations under CIO Mayotte. The enterprise focus remains strictly on Zero Trust architecture adoption, CJIS compliance, and ransomware resilience following devastating historical breaches.[16]

3. IT Governance & Service Delivery Model

The governance of information technology within Baltimore City is undergoing a profound and often turbulent evolution. The city is actively dismantling decades of decentralized, agency-led technology procurement in favor of a unified, enterprise-wide service delivery model. This transition is politically fraught, generating substantial friction as legacy agency fiefdoms are brought under the centralized control of BCIT.

Operating Model: Transitioning to a Consolidated Enterprise

Historically, Baltimore City operated under a highly fragmented, **Federated** IT model. Individual departments—such as the Department of Public Works (DPW), the Baltimore Police Department (BPD), and the Department of Transportation (DOT)—maintained their own independent IT organizations, procured their own proprietary applications, and managed isolated on-premises infrastructure.[21] While this model fostered departmental independence, it resulted in catastrophic inefficiencies, severe shadow IT sprawl, duplicative software licensing, and a highly porous cybersecurity perimeter that left the city vulnerable to debilitating ransomware attacks in previous years.

Under the current strategic plan, BCIT is aggressively driving a transition toward a **Consolidated/Shared Services** delivery model. The architectural mandate driving this consolidation is a strict "cloud-first, cloud-only" posture, aimed at virtualizing workloads and migrating them out of vulnerable agency data closets into secure, centralized enterprise environments or managed SaaS platforms.[21] To enforce this new governance structure, BCIT has established an Enterprise Portfolio Management Office (EPMO).[21] The EPMO acts as the

central clearinghouse for all technology demand management, ensuring that any new IT investments align with the city's broader strategic goals, adhere to stringent cybersecurity standards, and eliminate the procurement of redundant, best-of-breed software when an enterprise platform (such as Workday) is already available.[22]

Friction Points: Chargebacks, Audits, and Agency Resistance

The shift to a consolidated IT model is not seamless. It has introduced significant operational friction points, primarily revolving around cost recovery mechanisms, vendor oversight controversies, and stringent new cybersecurity workflows that agency personnel often view as bureaucratic bottlenecks.

The most systemic friction point lies within the city's **Internal Service Fund (ISF)** chargeback model. To fund centralized technology services without inflating the General Fund, BCIT utilizes ISF accounting. Under this model, the central IT authority bills individual city agencies for their proportional consumption of shared IT resources, including network access, data storage, enterprise software licensing, and hardware refresh programs.[23] A prime example is the 800 MHz Public Safety Radio network, which operates on an approximate $5.5 million ISF budget. BCIT redistributes these operational costs to the Police, Fire, and Public Works departments based precisely on the number of radio devices each agency actively utilizes.[25]

While ISF accounting is a standard SLG practice for cost recovery, it frequently breeds resentment. Operating agencies, already squeezed by tight budgets and high vacancy rates, often perceive BCIT's chargebacks as inflated or opaque. When agencies feel they are paying a premium for centralized storage or compute without seeing a commensurate increase in service quality, they actively attempt to bypass BCIT governance, seeking out rogue cloud solutions or shadow IT deployments.[26] For enterprise vendors, this means that any infrastructure pitch to BCIT must emphasize total cost of ownership (TCO) reduction and multi-tenancy efficiency, allowing the CIO to lower internal chargeback rates and alleviate political friction with department heads.

A second major friction point stems from intense vendor oversight and procurement scrutiny driven by the Office of the Inspector General (OIG). BCIT's ability to swiftly procure and deploy technology has been repeatedly hampered by high-profile contracting scandals. The most notable recent controversy involves the "Website Redesign Project" (PRJ002080). Initially awarded to Fearless Solutions for roughly $1.3 million, a lack of rigorous change-order monitoring, alleged "unnecessary coding," and poor project oversight caused the contract to balloon to $2.2 million, with total project costs approaching $4.8 million without delivering a fully functional, ADA-compliant website on schedule.[28] Similarly, the OIG uncovered fraudulent invoicing within the Mayor's Office of Neighborhood Safety and Engagement (MONSE) SideStep program, resulting in thousands of dollars of wasted taxpayer funds and an unauthorized data breach of juvenile records.[30] These highly publicized audits create an environment of extreme risk aversion within the Bureau of Procurement and BCIT, elongating sales cycles and requiring vendors to provide immaculate, line-item transparency for all

professional services and hardware deployments.

This internal friction extends to data governance and access control. Following an internal audit, BCIT recently had to revoke an unauthorized account associated with the Office of the Inspector General (OIG) that had gained unapproved and unrestricted access to confidential, attorney-client privileged legal files. This incident underscores the intense internal struggles regarding zero-trust enforcement and secure identity access management across city departments.

Finally, severe friction exists at the intersection of cybersecurity enforcement and financial operations. In early 2025, Baltimore City suffered a devastating $1.5 million Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT) fraud incident.[31] A malicious actor bypassed the city's geofencing protocols, infiltrated the newly implemented Workday enterprise resource planning (ERP) portal, and successfully altered the banking details of a legitimate municipal vendor, siphoning massive payments before the fraud was detected by the banking institution.[32] This catastrophic failure in Accounts Payable identity verification has forced BCIT to implement draconian new cybersecurity measures. The city is rapidly phasing out legacy "trust but verify" models in favor of rigorous Zero Trust architectures, mandating continuous authentication and rigid multi-factor authentication (MFA) across all endpoints and applications.[33] While necessary for cyber resilience, these abrupt security mandates cause intense operational friction, slowing down inter-agency workflows and frustrating end-users accustomed to seamless access.

4. Financials & Budget Breakdown

Understanding the flow of capital within Baltimore City requires navigating a bifurcated financial structure. The city meticulously separates its recurring operational expenditures from its net-new, long-term capital investments. This financial architecture is governed by rigid fiscal boundaries, strict grant compliance mandates, and the overarching oversight of the City Council's Budget and Appropriations Committee.

Total & IT Budget Architecture

The fiscal boundaries for Baltimore City operate on a standard state-aligned calendar, running from **July 1 through June 30** of the following year.[34] The appropriation of funds typically dictates that money for major capital investments becomes available at the start of the fiscal year in July, triggering a flurry of procurement activity and finalized contract awards in the late third and early fourth quarters of the calendar year as agencies move to execute their funded mandates.

For Fiscal Year 2026, the city's total Adopted Budget stands at approximately $4.63 billion.[3] The core engine of this budget is the General Fund, which accounts for roughly $2.45 billion to $2.9 billion of the total, depending on special fund redirections.[35] The General Fund is highly prized because it represents unrestricted revenue, primarily generated through aggressive local property taxes ($1.2 billion) and income taxes ($500 million), giving the Mayor and City Council broad discretion over its allocation.[4] A staggering 56% of this unrestricted General Fund is

immediately consumed by three entities: the Police Department ($641 million), the Fire Department ($362 million), and the Public School system.[4]

Within this operating framework, **BCIT's recurring operational spend (O&M) is approximately $53 million annually**.[4] This O&M budget is largely static and is dedicated to "keeping the lights on." It covers the salaries of the centralized IT workforce, ongoing software licensing and maintenance agreements, enterprise cloud hosting fees, helpdesk operations, and the baseline cybersecurity monitoring required to maintain the city's digital perimeter. Because this budget is heavily constrained by inflationary pressures and fixed personnel costs, BCIT has minimal flexibility to fund massive, net-new technological transformations from its operating ledger.

To execute major technological overhauls, BCIT relies on the **Capital Budget**, which specifically funds net-new project investments, infrastructure replacements, and major hardware acquisitions. The citywide Capital Budget for FY 2026 is $932 million.[3] The allocation of these funds is dictated by a rolling six-year Capital Improvement Program (CIP) developed by the Department of Planning.[36] For the current FY27-FY32 CIP planning cycle, BCIT has requested a total of $134.78 million across twenty distinct technology projects.[37] For the immediate upcoming fiscal year (FY27), BCIT is requesting **$11.33 million in direct capital funding**.[37] Capital IT projects are primarily financed through "Pay-As-You-Go" (PAYGO) general funds—cash on hand derived from budget surpluses—and the issuance of General Obligation (GO) Bonds, which require strict adherence to debt affordability guidelines.[36]

Grants & Influx Funding Ecosystem

Because local tax revenues are largely consumed by public safety and education, Baltimore City relies heavily on major influxes of federal and state grant dollars to finance its technological modernization and digital equity initiatives.

1. **American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA):** ARPA represents the most significant one-time infusion of capital for citywide technology in recent history. The administration allocated a historic $35 million in ARPA funding specifically targeting broadband expansion and digital equity.[12] This funding pool has been utilized to execute a massive $6 million procurement of 30,000 Chromebooks for low-income residents, to finance the deployment of the FreeBmoreWiFi network across dozens of municipal facilities, and to capitalize the local Digital Equity Fund.[11] Furthermore, ARPA funds are being used strategically to bridge capital gaps in enterprise IT projects, such as injecting $4 million into the modernization of the city's Tax Application system.[9]
2. **State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP):** As ransomware threats escalate, the city leverages federal cybersecurity grants administered through the Maryland Department of Emergency Management (MDEM).[39] The federal government has allocated significant tranches of SLCGP funding to the state—including over $12 million in recent fiscal years—with a mandate that 80% of funds be passed down to local governments.[40] Baltimore City utilizes these funds to harden its digital perimeter, deploy

Zero Trust architectures, and fulfill the stringent identity access management (IAM) requirements enacted after recent EFT fraud incidents.[41]

3. **Federal Infrastructure and Transit Bills:** While not exclusively IT-focused, massive federal infrastructure grants carry heavy technological requirements. A prime example is the $1 billion Light Rail Modernization Program (LRMP) managed in conjunction with the state transit authority.[43] This project involves the complete replacement of aging signaling systems, the deployment of optimized traffic control operations, and the installation of modern, IP-based station security and accessibility networks, generating downstream requirements for ruggedized edge compute and resilient data transmission.[43]

5. Strategic Initiatives & Projects

BCIT's operational roadmap is dictated by the requirements laid out in the Capital Improvement Program (CIP). An analysis of the FY27–FY32 CIP requests reveals that the city's technology strategy is heavily weighted toward replacing fragile legacy applications, fortifying public safety communications, and managing the explosive growth of unstructured surveillance data.

The following represent the top three funded modernization efforts currently dominating the city's IT landscape:

1. Tax Application Modernization (Project PRJ003238)

- **The Executive Mandate:** The primary driver for this initiative is enhancing the citizen experience and ensuring responsible financial stewardship. The city's current tax management infrastructure is antiquated, leading to severe processing delays, a lack of transparency for taxpayers, and elevated operational costs. The mandate is to deliver a highly robust, user-friendly, and fully modernized tax system that accelerates revenue collection and drastically increases the efficiency of municipal finance personnel.[9]
- **Owning Agency:** The Department of Finance, with architectural oversight and implementation managed directly by BCIT.
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** This is a massive application modernization effort with an estimated total cost of $18.6 million, funded via $12.6 million in BCIT Capital and $4 million in ARPA funds, with an additional $2 million requested for FY27.[9] The technical requirement involves transitioning the city away from a costly, monolithic on-premises infrastructure toward a modern, scalable Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) or highly virtualized hybrid-cloud environment.[37] This transition requires complex data migration from legacy mainframes, the establishment of secure, highly available backend databases, and rigorous integration with the city's newly deployed Workday ERP system to ensure seamless financial reporting and prevent the type of EFT fraud experienced in early 2025.

2. CAD (Computer Aided Dispatch) Replacement (Project PRJ003241)

- **The Executive Mandate:** Public safety is the paramount political priority for the Scott administration. The existing Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) system—the technological heartbeat used to route 911 calls to police, fire, and EMS personnel—is reaching end-of-life and suffers from reliability issues. The mandate is to deploy a next-generation CAD system that ensures faster processing of emergency calls, optimizes the routing of first responders, and features an intuitive user design to minimize training time and eliminate life-threatening dispatch errors.[9]
- **Owning Agency:** A joint deployment owned by the Baltimore Police Department (BPD), the Baltimore City Fire Department (BCFD), and the Office of Emergency Management, with BCIT serving as the technical lead.
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** Slated for heavy capital funding ($11.5 million) between FY28 and FY29, the CAD replacement represents the most mission-critical workload in the city's portfolio.[9] The underlying IT requirements demand absolute zero-downtime architecture. This necessitates the deployment of high-availability compute clusters, ultra-low latency flash storage to process real-time geospatial and telemetry data, and an ironclad Disaster Recovery (DR) posture. The infrastructure must support active-active data center configurations and immutable backup vaults to ensure that dispatch capabilities remain operational even in the event of a catastrophic ransomware strike or physical infrastructure failure.

3. Public Safety Communications & CitiWatch Infrastructure (Projects PRJ002680, PRJ003465, PRJ003464)

- **The Executive Mandate:** Cyber resilience and real-time situational awareness. The administration requires unbroken, redundant communication networks for emergency personnel and comprehensive video surveillance coverage to support the Group Violence Reduction Strategy.[6]
- **Owning Agency:** Office of Emergency Management (OEM) and BCIT.
- **The Underlying IT Requirement:** This initiative is a multi-tiered, highly complex infrastructure overhaul. It includes a staggering $21 million request to replace aging 800 MHz radios (PRJ002680) and a critical $2.5 million investment to construct an 800 MHz Georedundant Site (PRJ003465) to ensure continuous data availability and network failover capabilities during disasters.[9] Concurrently, the city is requesting $11.33 million (PRJ003464) to replace unsupported infrastructure supporting the CitiWatch program.[9] The CitiWatch network comprises over 850 high-definition surveillance cameras deployed across the city.[9] The IT requirement for this component is massive: the city must architect and deploy scale-out Network Attached Storage (NAS) capable of ingesting, retaining, and analyzing petabytes of unstructured video data, while ensuring that the edge computing hardware at the camera endpoints remains secure and integrated with the central network.

(Note: BCIT currently manages 1.89 PB of primary storage data and 3 PB of backup storage data, a footprint that will expand exponentially as the CitiWatch network and new CAD systems

come online [9]).

6. Procurement, Vendor Landscape, & Compliance

Selling enterprise technology into Baltimore City requires navigating a highly regulated procurement landscape defined by strict state oversight, a heavy reliance on regional cooperative purchasing agreements, and aggressive new compliance mandates surrounding cybersecurity and artificial intelligence.

Procurement Vehicles & Preferred Methods

To circumvent the protracted timelines associated with drafting bespoke Requests for Proposals (RFPs), BCIT heavily favors utilizing pre-established, competitively bid contract vehicles and cooperative purchasing agreements.

- **Baltimore Metropolitan Council (BRCPC):** Baltimore City is a primary stakeholder in this regional cooperative, which allows the city's purchasing officers to aggregate buying power and "piggyback" on contracts established by surrounding jurisdictions like Anne Arundel, Howard, and Harford counties.[45]
- **National Cooperatives:** For broad IT solutions, cloud services, and commodity hardware, the city frequently leverages national cooperative agreements, specifically **OMNIA Partners** and **NASPO ValuePoint**.[46] These vehicles are highly preferred for rapid procurement of end-user computing devices, software licensing (e.g., Microsoft Enterprise Agreements), and standardized networking gear.
- **State of Maryland Master Contracts:** The most critical avenue for complex enterprise IT sales is through the State of Maryland's Department of Information Technology (DoIT) master contracts. BCIT frequently utilizes the **CATS+** (Consulting and Technical Services) vehicle for professional services, staff augmentation, and strategic advisory engagements.[49] For physical infrastructure, the city relies on the **Hardware and Associated Equipment and Services 2012 (BPO 060B2490022)** master contract.[49]
- **Purchasing Methods:** For infrastructure acquisitions, the Bureau of Procurement typically executes a "Secondary Competition" by issuing a Purchase Order Request for Proposals (PORFP) exclusively to the pre-qualified vendor pool on these master contracts.[52] Following the recent modernization of their financial systems, all vendor interactions, invoicing, and EFT management are now strictly handled through the **Workday** platform.[32]

The Battlefield: Vendor Footprint and Competitive Dynamics

The enterprise infrastructure landscape within Baltimore City and the broader Maryland SLG region is a fiercely contested battleground, primarily dominated by a few entrenched incumbents.

- **Compute & Storage: Dell Technologies** maintains a formidable and highly strategic footprint within the region. Recent state and local Board of Estimates awards indicate a

heavy reliance on Dell infrastructure for mission-critical tier-one workloads. For example, the region utilizes Dell PowerMax SANs to host critical law enforcement databases like the Criminal Justice Information System (CJIS) and the Maryland Automated Fingerprint System (MAFIS).[53] Furthermore, Dell EMC Unity arrays and VxRail hyperconverged infrastructure (HCI) are prevalent in local data centers.[54] However, **Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE)** is executing aggressive competitive displacement campaigns in the immediate vicinity; notably, neighboring Harford County recently approved a $436,000 project to rip and replace their existing Dell VxRail cluster with HPE vSAN ready nodes to host their Department of Emergency Services.[55] **Cisco** also maintains a strong presence in the unified computing space. Dell also faces emerging threats in the hyperconverged infrastructure (HCI) space from **Nutanix**. Regional state agencies that utilize the same master contracts as the city, such as the Maryland Aviation Administration, are actively procuring Nutanix Cloud Infrastructure and Nutanix server nodes.

- **Endpoints & Digital Equity:** In the traditional client solutions space, Dell is highly entrenched, with recent state-level PORFPs seeking high-end Dell Pro Max laptops for agency personnel.[52] However, in the rapidly expanding "Digital Equity" space—fueled by the $35 million ARPA allocation—the city is procuring massive fleets of lower-cost devices. A recent acquisition saw the city distribute nearly 30,000 Chromebooks to low-income residents, highlighting a massive market for Google-integrated hardware ecosystems.[11]
- **Networking & Edge:** In the realm of public safety communications and edge networking, **Motorola Solutions** exercises near-monopoly control over the 800 MHz radio network and related interoperability systems across the entire Maryland National Capital Region.[56] For core enterprise data center networking, **Cisco** remains the dominant incumbent, though BCIT has explicitly earmarked $1.5 million for a "Network Switch Refresh" (PRJ002077) to replace aging, unsupported switches, presenting an immediate competitive battleground.[9]

Compliance: The Regulatory Drivers

Any technology proposed to Baltimore City must rigorously adhere to a tightening web of regulatory and compliance frameworks.

- **Zero Trust & Identity Mandates:** Reeling from the $1.5 million Workday EFT fraud incident and historical ransomware attacks, the state and city have officially abandoned the legacy "trust but verify" security posture. Under the new statewide cybersecurity framework, agencies must adopt strict **Zero Trust Access** architectures within an 18-month window.[33] Vendors must demonstrate that their solutions support continuous identity validation, robust Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and comply with StateRAMP equivalent cloud security controls.[33]
- **CJIS Compliance:** With the upcoming $11.5 million CAD replacement and ongoing CitiWatch expansions, any compute or storage infrastructure touching law enforcement data must adhere strictly to FBI Criminal Justice Information Services (CJIS) data

protection standards, requiring end-to-end encryption and stringent access auditing.[53]

- **AI Governance:** The State of Maryland has proactively established an AI Subcabinet and Task Force to regulate the deployment of Artificial Intelligence.[59] Any vendor pitching AI solutions—whether generative or predictive—must navigate new policies demanding algorithmic transparency, the mitigation of racial and economic bias, and strict data sovereignty to ensure constituent data is not unlawfully ingested into public large language models (LLMs).[60]

7. Actionable Dell Opportunities

Based on Baltimore City's $932 million capital posture [3], the centralized governance structure under CIO T.J. Mayotte, and the explicit technical requirements mapped out in BCIT's FY27–FY32 Capital Improvement Program, Dell Technologies is uniquely positioned to execute the following highly targeted sales motions:

Funded Alignment

- **CAD Replacement & Public Safety Resilience (PowerStore & PowerProtect):** With $11.5 million allocated for the CAD system replacement (PRJ003241) and $2.5 million for an 800 MHz Georedundant Site (PRJ003465) [9], absolute continuous availability is required. Dell should aggressively position **PowerStore** all-flash arrays to deliver the sub-millisecond latency required for real-time 911 dispatch mapping. Crucially, Dell must attach **PowerProtect Data Manager** and an air-gapped **Cyber Recovery Vault**. Positioning this architecture directly addresses the CIO's mandate to protect against ransomware and guarantees that the city's most critical life-safety data remains immutable and rapidly recoverable.
- **Tax Application Modernization (Dell APEX):** The city has budgeted $18.6 million (including $4M in ARPA funds) to modernize its monolithic tax application system.[9] As BCIT seeks a modern, scalable solution, Dell should pitch **APEX Custom Solutions** (specifically APEX Flex on Demand). This allows the city to achieve the agility and OPEX-like consumption of the public cloud while maintaining the stringent data sovereignty, performance, and security controls of on-premises infrastructure, mitigating the risks associated with moving highly sensitive financial data into multi-tenant public clouds.
- **Digital Equity Expansion (Client Solutions Group):** BCIT has already distributed nearly 30,000 Chromebooks via ARPA funding [11] and is actively expanding the FreeBmoreWiFi network to 45 recreation centers and 8 senior centers.[11] Dell should leverage its OMNIA and NASPO contracts to continue aggressively positioning **Latitude Chromebooks**, ruggedized endpoints for public spaces, and **OptiPlex Micro** form factors to serve as the hardware backbone for these newly connected community tech hubs.

Whitespace & Advisory

- **CitiWatch Unstructured Data Sprawl (PowerScale / Isilon):** BCIT is currently managing

over 1.89 PB of primary storage and 3 PB of backup data, a figure that is compounding rapidly due to the 850+ high-definition cameras in the CitiWatch network.[9] With $11.33 million requested for CitiWatch infrastructure upgrades (PRJ003464), Dell faces a massive whitespace opportunity in unstructured data management. Dell Advisory Services should lead a workshop on data lifecycle management, positioning **PowerScale (Isilon)** as the premier scale-out NAS for video surveillance. Dell can demonstrate immediate ROI by showing BCIT how to seamlessly tier aging, "cold" video data to **ECS (Elastic Cloud Storage)**, drastically reducing the physical footprint and cost of their massive video archives.

- **AI-Ready Infrastructure & Sovereign Data Governance:** As the state enforces rigorous new AI governance and anti-bias mandates [60], BCIT will be highly hesitant to leverage public Generative AI platforms for civic data analytics. Dell Advisory should engage Chief Data Officer Justin Elszasz and CIO T.J. Mayotte to outline the **Dell AI Factory with NVIDIA**. By pitching specialized PowerEdge XE servers optimized for local inferencing, Dell can help the city build private, on-premises AI environments that comply with state zero-trust policies, allowing the city to safely leverage AI for performance management (CitiStat) without exposing sensitive constituent data to external LLMs.

Competitive Displacement

- **Aging Network Infrastructure (PowerSwitch vs. Cisco):** BCIT has explicitly earmarked $1.5 million in the near term for a "Network Switch Refresh" (PRJ002077) to replace outdated, unsupported switches across the city's network.[9] Dell has a prime rip-and-replace opportunity to displace the aging Cisco footprint by aggressively bundling **Dell PowerSwitch** data center networking with upcoming PowerEdge server refreshes, offering a unified, single-vendor management pane.
- **Overcoming ISF Chargeback Friction (VxRail / HCI):** The internal political friction caused by BCIT's Internal Service Fund (ISF) chargebacks is a major pain point for agency directors.[27] Furthermore, Dell faces active regional threats from HPE and emerging HCI competition from Nutanix. Dell must counterattack by pitching the next generation of **VxRail** hyperconverged infrastructure to BCIT. By demonstrating how VxRail's extreme density and automated lifecycle management drastically reduce administrative overhead, power, and cooling costs, Dell can show the CIO exactly how to lower internal chargeback rates to constituent agencies. This not only displaces competing 3-tier architectures but directly solves the CIO's political friction with operating departments.

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